

Core move

Pause for one quiet beat before or after a key line so the line can land.

Minimum viable move

After an important sentence, close your mouth and count one slow beat before adding anything else.

Field tip

A strategic pause is not empty space. It is a decision not to trample the moment with extra words. The pause works best when it is brief, warm and attached to a real conversational job. Field tip: The most useful pause is often after the sentence you are most tempted to explain. Say the clean line, breathe once, and let the other person meet it before you add anything else.